Townlight Access User Manual

Windows staff workflow — 0.5.0 candidate

This candidate is prepared; exact signed-installer acceptance is pending. It supports a fresh profile only. Keep the previous release with any existing unmarked profile. The compatibility profile directory remains `%LOCALAPPDATA%\CivicSuite`; the new program refuses to adopt existing unmarked city data.

1. Sign in with an account allowed to use Access and enable the Access capability. Open Accessibility and enter the actual source title, text, language and image-description information.
2. Save the review. Reopen it to inspect the source, deterministic findings and any saved local-model advice, model identity and outcome. Advice is not a certified accessibility finding or approval.
3. For plain-language or translation work, enter the actual source and request a draft. The Windows path uses the suite's configured local model. Saved drafts retain source/output, language, model/outcome, staff actor/time and the requirement for qualified human review. An unavailable-model sample is labeled as a sample; it is not a translation of the input.
4. Reopen saved drafts from Access, including after restarting the app. Select Export record on the desired review or draft. The desktop writes a Markdown record and verifies its content hash and companion manifest before reporting completion. The fenced JSON is the complete record, including source, output/advice and relevant provenance; ordinary HTML rendering is unnecessary to read it.
5. To hand the record to Records, open the intended Records request, attach the actual exported Markdown file using Records' native file picker, and read it back from that request. A successful Access export alone does not attach evidence to a request or authorize disclosure. Records permissions and review/release rules still apply.

The complete review export includes reviewed source, findings, saved advice/model/outcome where available, actor/time, relevant audit history and advisory limits. Draft exports include the retained source/output pair and review status. Back up the complete profile using System Health and restore only a matching new-format backup. Preservation of these additions on the actual installed candidate remains part of acceptance.

No automated result certifies ADA compliance, creates an accessible/tagged PDF, approves publication or replaces a qualified translator or ADA coordinator.

Standalone support service

The separately run FastAPI service provides deterministic checks and planning helpers. Its Spanish and Vietnamese responses are fixed samples, **not translations of the supplied source**. Its deterministic jargon substitutions are separate from the Windows model workflow. A shared

write token proves possession of that token; it does not establish an individual staff identity. Standalone audit records use `shared-token-staff` for that reason.

Standalone saved-review exports now return a complete Markdown artifact with source, findings and relevant audit provenance, plus its SHA-256. The staff page offers that actual artifact for download. Other form, tagged-PDF, ADA and publishing helpers remain checklists. The standalone service does not acquire Windows draft persistence or native individual-account identity merely because it shares this package.

Version 0.5.0 · prepared candidate; installed acceptance pending Townlight Access is the accessibility, plain-language, multilingual, and ADA Title II review-support module for Townlight.

This manual has two parts. Read the one that fits your role:

- **Part 1 — For Civic Staff** — clerks, communicators, ADA coordinators. Plain English, no setup.
- **Part 2 — For IT & Technical Staff** — architecture, runtime, data model, security, and operations.

Part 1 — For Civic Staff

What Townlight Access is for

Townlight Access helps your office put out public notices, forms, and documents that **everyone can read** — and keep a clean record proving you checked. It is a staff tool that gives advice and does the busywork; **you and your ADA coordinator always make the final call.**

What you can do with it

You want to…	Townlight Access gives you…
Know if a notice is hard to read	A check that flags missing titles, images without descriptions, and dense wording — each with a specific fix
Cut the jargon	A plain-language rewrite (e.g. “remit payment prior to the deadline” → “pay before the deadline”)
Reach non-English readers	Windows local-model drafts for qualified review; fixed standalone samples do not translate input
Publish an accessible form or PDF	A checklist of what an accessible form or tagged PDF needs
Handle an ADA Title II review	A step-by-step review-support checklist
Answer a records request	A saved, exportable record of every review,

You want to…	Townlight Access gives you…
	with provenance (individual staff identity in Windows; shared-token identity in the standalone service)

How you'll use it day to day

There are two places to work, and the difference matters:

- The **public checker** is for trying things out — it forgets everything when you leave.
- The **staff workspace** is for keeping a permanent, official record you can produce later.

Your IT team will give you the link to each.

1. Open the **public checker**. Paste in a draft notice and run the check. You'll get a list of plain-language fixes — nothing is saved, so it's a safe place to experiment.
2. When you're ready to keep a review on the record, open the **staff workspace** and enter the staff password your IT team gave you (a one-time setup). Save the review — it goes into your Townlight records with a time-stamp of who saved it and when.
3. From the staff workspace, **export a records-ready package** for any saved review — ready to hand to a public-records request.

What Townlight Access will *not* do

Townlight Access is a tool for your staff, **not a rubber stamp.** It does **not**:

- give legal advice,
- certify ADA compliance,
- issue official translations, or
- publish anything on its own.

A qualified human — your staff, an ADA coordinator, a translator, legal counsel — always reviews and approves before anything goes public. Translations it drafts are **starting points for a human translator**, never the final word.

Where it stands today

This is **v0.5.0, an early release** we're being upfront about. It's solid enough to evaluate and pilot, but it is **not a finished 1.0 and not a compliance guarantee.** (An earlier `v1.0.0` was published by mistake; we pulled it back to an honest sub-1.0 label rather than overstate where the product is.)

Part 2 — For IT & Technical Staff

Overview

Townlight Access is a deterministic **FastAPI** service, written in Python and pinned to the published **Townlight Core 1.3.0.dev2** release wheel. It performs rule-based accessibility checks — **no LLM/model calls, no network calls** — so output is reproducible and the service is cheap to run. It ships as one module inside **Townlight Windows Local**, a Tauri/WebView2 desktop application, and is also runnable standalone for development.

Deployment architecture

In Townlight Windows Local, a Tauri **supervisor** starts a bundled Python host (running Townlight Access alongside peer modules) and a bundled **PostgreSQL** instance on `127.0.0.1:15432`. The supervisor injects a `DATABASE_URL` into each module service; Townlight Access stores its data in a dedicated `townlight_access` schema in that shared cluster. The supervisor's backup copies the entire data directory (including the Postgres cluster), so Townlight Access data is captured with it.

```
flowchart TB
  Resident["Resident<br/>(browser)"] -->|"public, read-only"|
Pub["/townlight_access"]
  Staff["City staff<br/>(browser)"] -->|"WebView2 UI"|
StaffUI["/townlight_access/staff"]

  subgraph Sup["Tauri supervisor — local machine only"]
    CA["Townlight Access<br/>(FastAPI)"]
    Peers["Peer modules<br/>Townlight Meetings · Townlight Code · Townlight
Notice · …"]
    PG[("Bundled PostgreSQL<br/>127.0.0.1:15432")]
  end

  Pub --> CA
  StaffUI --> CA
  CA -->|"DATABASE_URL → townlight_access schema"| PG
  Peers --> PG
  CA -->|"depends on"| Core["Townlight Core 1.3.0.dev2"]
  CA -. "records-export hand-off" .-> Records["Townlight Records"]
  Sup -. "wholesale backup of Data/ (incl. Data/postgres)" .->
Backup[("Backup folder")]
```

Request & trust model

There are two surfaces with deliberately different trust levels:

- **Public** (`/townlight_access` → `POST /api/v1/townlight_access/analyze`): stateless. Anyone can analyze content; **nothing is persisted and no token is required.**

- **Staff** (`/townlight_access/staff` → `POST .../review`, `POST .../reviews/{id}/records-export`): persistent. Every write requires the **trusted-write token**.

```
sequenceDiagram
  participant R as Resident (public)
  participant S as City staff
  participant CA as Townlight Access
  participant DB as PostgreSQL (townlight_access schema)

  R->>CA: POST /analyze (no token)
  CA-->>R: findings + fixes (nothing saved)

  S->>CA: POST /review + X-Townlight-Access-Write-Token
  Note over CA: constant-time token check<br/>403 if invalid · 503 if
unconfigured
  CA->>DB: insert review + audit row (one transaction)
  CA-->>S: saved review_id + findings

  S->>CA: POST /reviews/{id}/records-export + token
  CA->>DB: write audit_events row
  CA-->>S: records-ready export
```

Persistence & configuration

Townlight Access resolves its review store in this order:

1. `TOWNLIGHT_ACCESS_REVIEW_DB_URL` — explicit override (a dev SQLite path or a pre-built Postgres URL).
2. `DATABASE_URL` — the supervisor-injected async URL (`postgresql+asyncpg://…:15432/…`), converted to a synchronous psycopg2 URL. **This is the default under the desktop runtime.**
3. **SQLite dev fallback** — `data/townlight_access-reviews.db` under `TOWNLIGHT_ACCESS_DATA_DIR` (default: `./data`), used only when neither variable is set.

Variable	Purpose
`DATABASE_URL`	Shared Townlight Core PostgreSQL (set by the supervisor) — the production default
`TOWNLIGHT_ACCESS_REVIEW_DB_URL`	Explicit SQLAlchemy URL override
`TOWNLIGHT_ACCESS_DATA_DIR`	Directory for the SQLite dev fallback
`TOWNLIGHT_ACCESS_TRUSTED_WRITE_TOKEN`	**Required** server secret for persistent writes

`townlight_access-db-status` (console script) preflights a database with an explicit URL.

Data model

Three tables live in the `townlight_access` schema (translated to the default schema on SQLite). Schema setup is non-destructive (`CREATE SCHEMA IF NOT EXISTS` + `metadata.create_all`); the applied migration id is `townlight_access-windows-local-state-v1`.

```
erDiagram
  accessibility_review_records {
    string   review_id PK
    string   title
    text     body
    bool     has_alt_text
    string   language
    string   status
    json     findings
    text     disclaimer
    datetime created_at
  }
  audit_events {
    string   event_id PK
    string   action
    string   subject_id "soft ref → review_id"
    string   actor
    datetime created_at
  }
  schema_migrations {
    string   schema_version PK
    datetime applied_at
  }
```

HTTP API

Method & path	Auth	Persists?	Purpose
`GET /`	—	no	Module status and boundaries
`GET /health`	—	no	Package + Townlight Core version
`GET /ready`, `GET /api/v1/townlight_access/readiness`	—	no	Persistence readiness gate
`GET /townlight_access`	—	no	Public accessibility checker (UI)
`GET /townlight_access/staff`	—	no	Staff workspace (UI; never embeds the token)
`POST /api/v1/townlight_access/analyze`	—	no	Stateless accessibility analysis
`POST /api/v1/townlight_access/review`	**token**	**yes**	Save a review record (+ audit)
`GET /api/v1/townlight`	—	no	List saved reviews

Method & path	Auth	Persists?	Purpose
`_access/reviews`			
`GET /api/v1/townlight_access/reviews/{id}`	—	no	Retrieve a saved review
`POST /api/v1/townlight_access/reviews/{id}/records-export`	**token**	**yes** (audit)	Records-ready export (+ audit)
`GET /api/v1/townlight_access/integration-contracts`	—	no	Published integration contracts
`POST /api/v1/townlight_access/plain-language`	—	no	Deterministic plain-language rewrite
`POST /api/v1/townlight_access/language-variant`	—	no	Multilingual draft variant (human-review flagged)
`POST /api/v1/townlight_access/forms`	—	no	Accessible form publication checks
`POST /api/v1/townlight_access/publishing-workflow`	—	no	Staff publication workflow steps/blockers
`POST /api/v1/townlight_access/ada-title-ii`	—	no	ADA Title II review-support checklist
`POST /api/v1/townlight_access/tagged-pdf`	—	no	Tagged-PDF heading expectations
`POST /api/v1/townlight_access/export`	—	no	Records-ready export checklist (stateless)

Token-guarded writes require the `X-Townlight-Access-Write-Token` header matching `TOWNLIGHT_ACCESS_TRUSTED_WRITE_TOKEN` (compared in constant time). Missing/invalid → `403`; guard not configured → `503` (fails closed). The server token is never embedded in served

HTML — the staff page provides a field where an operator pastes it; it is kept only in the browser session.

Security

- **Authentication boundary:** persistence-write routes require the trusted-write token; read and stateless-analysis routes are open. The desktop supervisor binds the service to the local machine.
- **Audit trail:** every persistent write/export writes an `audit_events` row (action, subject, actor, timestamp). `review.create` is committed atomically with the review record.
- **Determinism:** no model/LLM calls and no outbound network calls; checks are pure functions.
- **Backups:** review and audit data live in the shared Postgres cluster, captured by the supervisor's wholesale `Data/` backup. Durability is covered by the test suite (a Postgres reconnect round-trip for the default store; a SQLite file backup/restore round-trip for the dev fallback).

Operations

Readiness: poll `GET /ready` (or `/api/v1/townlight_access/readiness`) — `ready` when the schema can be created and verified.

Local verification (mirrors CI; the release gate requires a real PostgreSQL):

```
python -m pip install
https://github.com/townlight/core/releases/download/v1.2.0/townlight_core-1.2
.0-py3-none-any.whl
python -m pip install -e ".[dev]"
# Release gate (requires Postgres):
export
TOWNLIGHT_ACCESS_POSTGRES_TEST_URL="postgresql+psycopg2://USER:PW@HOST:PORT/
DB"
bash scripts/verify-release.sh
```

Integration

Townlight Access **depends on Townlight Core**; Townlight Core does not depend on Townlight Access. It publishes integration contracts at `/api/v1/townlight_access/integration-contracts`, hands records exports to **Townlight Records**, and provides accessibility support to downstream publishers (zone, plan, permit, inspect, grants, procure).

Release status

`v0.5.0` is an early release. Probe gaps #1–#4 (clean install, staff/public authz, audit logging, backup/restore durability) are closed with evidence (see `PROBE-PROGRESS.md`). City-core membership (desktop registry record + 6-module profile) and a clean-VM accessibility acceptance pass are later phases. The earlier `v1.0.0` tag was published in error and is retained only as historical evidence.